humanity, mercy and justice.’[11] The only answer, as he saw it, was to bring in an outsider. To do so was ‘one of the greatest evils’, he admitted, but ‘necessarily resorted to as a good, to mitigate the still more intolerable grievances of injustice and oppression’. So on Munro’s advice Rani Lakshmi Bayi dismissed and exiled the serving Dewan and asked the Company to allow Munro to take his place. Accordingly, in 1811 the British Resident at Travancore and Cochin became also, and uniquely, the Dewan of both. This gave Munro virtually dictatorial powers which, to his credit, he exercised wisely.



Rani Gowri Lakshmi Bayi, queen of Travancore for three years and then regent up to her death in 1815.